



Boost to Internet Speed

MIT and CalTech researchers have developed a new technique that could boost up internet speeds by 10 times <http://dgit.in/InternetBoost>



FitRider bike workout

New bike design gives both your arms and legs a workout while riding <http://dgit.in/FitRider>

Industry Connect

Demystifying the cool new Yahoo!

One of the oldest, most homely destinations on the Web, Yahoo has cleaned its cobwebs and turned a new leaf. Full of renewed vigour and dynamism, the company is starting to wow users once more, and win over new ones. We spoke to Hari Vasudevan, VP & Head, Yahoo India R&D, about how Yahoo's changing under Marissa Mayer, the innovative products it's building and the bold new direction it's headed. Excerpts:

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How have things changed under Marissa Mayer?

Hari: Overall, since Marissa's come on-board, we're treating this very much as a marathon with a combination of series of sprints. The momentum that Marissa's created, especially working with the leadership team to drive a cultural transformation across the company. From things like free smartphones to dramatically increasing the transparency within the company, from how employees work collaboratively with each other to re-designing the workplace for teams to work like startups, all geared towards quickly building and launching products. She's ensured on one hand that there's nothing standing between people being as productive as they can be, but on the other hand focusing on the culture and making Yahoo an innovative and fun place to work at.

How has Yahoo India contributed to Yahoo's recent global success?

Hari: We at Yahoo India R&D don't think ourselves as a separate entity from Yahoo global, for instance, and it's important to understand this difference. All of our teams are very tightly integrated across geographies, especially given the extremely collaborative nature of how we work together. All of our teams here in Bangalore are very tightly interwoven with global teams, and they have been heavily involved in a number of recent Yahoo product launches. To give you a couple of specific examples, with respect to the FIFA World Cup coverage, that's



Hari Vasudevan, VP & Head, Yahoo India R&D

something that our teams in Bangalore have been very actively working on. They've been instrumental in building a truly world class World Cup experience for users globally, not just in India. We also have teams working in areas as diverse as Yahoo Groups, and others working on Yahoo's platform products for content ingestion by helping Yahoo sites worldwide have the best content for display in a very personalized way. Point is that we've teams that span multiple initiatives, that work in very closed collaboration with their counterparts within rest of Yahoo – that can be anywhere from the US to our Taiwan hubs.

How's Yahoo attacking the mobile space?

Hari: If you look at some of the 40 odd acquisitions we've made since Marissa's come onboard, many of them have been with the view of building a very strong mobile talent base within the company.

Even if you look at Tumblr, which is one of our biggest acquisitions, it has a strong young demographic that accesses the service through mobile channels. So clearly mobile is extremely important for us and it's critical.

To give you a couple of examples, we released Yahoo Weather last year, which was an absolutely kickass experience that worked in conjunction with Flickr, and it actually went on to win the Apple Design Award. This year we followed it up again with Yahoo News Digest release which also won the same award this year. We're definitely taking a mobile first approach and you're going to see that translated in many of our products. But the overall idea is not just to launch mobile apps but create much more holistic web experiences.

Is search still an important battleground for Yahoo?

Hari: If you look at Yahoo's overall business, we focus on four pillars: Search, Communications, Digital Magazines and Videos. Our approach has been to build the best products in the world across all these pillars. To that effect, search continues to be a critical priority for us, simply because it's the ultimate daily habit. We continue to work with Microsoft in terms of the backend of our search engines and we continue to innovate on the frontend of search very rapidly. Yes, there's tremendous opportunity to innovate on the frontend of search and we continue to experiment with those opportunities on a daily basis. **Digit**

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